



Visual Style Guide

User Edition

A practical guide for consistent Region South presentations, dashboards, data stories, and AI-generated graphics.

Region South logo area

Region South Style Guide

Light and Dark Background Options

LAUSD logo area

LIGHT MODE

Clean, high-contrast experience optimized for print and data-heavy reports.

REGION SOUTH INITIATIVE As of May 2026*

Grade 11 Math

Distance from Proficiency (DFP) Over Time

MATH

-49

DFP

▲ 8 pts vs. 2025

ELA

-2

DFP

▼ 2 pts vs. 2025

SCIENCE

+5

SP

▲ 3 pts vs. 2025

*2026 results are preliminary and embargoed.

Sample Line Chart (Math)

Higher DFP Is Better Proficiency (DFP = 0)

Year	DFP
2019	-64
2020	-82
2021	-77
2022	-70
2023	-57
2024	-49*
2025	-49*
2026	-49*

*2026 results are preliminary and embargoed.

KEY TAKEAWAY (Sample)

- ✓ All grade levels improved from 2023 to 2026*.
- ✓ Grade 11 Math improved 8 points vs. 2025.
- ✓ Science Points increased 3 points vs. 2025.

COLOR PALETTE (Sample)

MATH (Blue)

ELA (Orange)

Science (Green)

Neutrals

Best for printed reports

Best for regional comparison charts

Use dark text for readability

DARK MODE

Bold, immersive experience optimized for presentations and digital screens.

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COLOR PALETTE (Sample)

MATH (Blue)

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Science (Green)

Neutrals

Best for title slides and hero dashboards

Best for executive presentations

Use light plot areas for detailed charts

Recommended Guide Rule: Support both Light Mode and Dark Mode. Choose the mode based on audience, readability, and chart complexity.

Dark Mode is in scope as an approved alternate presentation mode, not a departure from the guide.

Professional | Data-driven | Student-centered | Modern | Optimistic | Clear

Quick Start

The rules most users need before creating a Region South graphic.

Core priority: Data accuracy > Brand compliance > Readability > Correct subject identity > Student representation > Aesthetic polish.

1. Choose a display mode

Light Mode or Dark Mode must be chosen before final generation. If the user has not specified one, ask.

3. Identify the subject

Math = blue. ELA = orange. Science/CAST = green. Subject determines the color family.

5. Use approved terminology

P+A = Proficient + Advanced; DFP = Distance from Proficiency; SP = Science Points.

2. Resolve metadata

Ask for Source and download/data-as-of Date when missing. Explicitly allow either to be omitted if not pertinent.

4. Select a template

RS-01 Hero Data, RS-02 Regional Comparison, or RS-03 Cohort Analysis.

6. Verify before publishing

Check data values, definitions, authentic logos, contrast, source/date, and embargo restrictions.

Do not improvise brand rules when a Region South standard already exists.

1. Brand Foundation

The Region South visual system is a presentation and communication framework operating within the LAUSD brand environment. It does not replace the official LAUSD identity.

- Professional
- Data-driven
- Student-centered
- Modern
- Optimistic
- Clear

Official brand assets

Use the canonical Region South and LAUSD logo files. Never redraw, recolor, distort, crop, or approximate official logos.

If an AI cannot reproduce an authentic logo, reserve clean space and insert the official asset afterward. An authentic missing logo is better than an inaccurate generated logo.

Brand hierarchy

LAUSD -> Region South -> specific program, subject, or data story.

2. Approved Display Modes



LIGHT MODE

Best for print, dense analytical charts, regional comparisons, detailed tables, and maximum color contrast.

DARK MODE

Best for presentations, executive dashboards, hero graphics, title slides, student photography, and large-screen display.

Required interaction: If the user has not specified Light or Dark Mode, ask. If they request a recommendation, recommend one and obtain confirmation before final generation.

3. Color System

Subject determines the color family. Region determines the shade.

Color	Hex	Use
LAUSD Navy	#00237A	Math anchor / institutional blue
Bright Blue	#0089FF	Math secondary / digital accent
LAUSD Green	#00602D	Science / CAST anchor
LAUSD Orange	#FF4D00	ELA anchor
LAUSD Gold	#FF9C00	Highlight
LAUSD Red	#FF0000	Warning / decline

Locked regional comparison palette

Recommended Region South Regional Comparison Palette

Subject determines the color family. Region determines the shade.

MATH — Blue Family

South #00237A	East #0089FF	North #001A5A	West #6F8FAF
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ELA — Orange Family

South #FF4D00	East #FF8A4C	North #B93600	West #C97A55
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SCIENCE — Green Family

South #00602D	East #5CBF82	North #003D1D	West #70947F
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Recommended use South = focal series; East = light; North = deep; West = muted.

Use these exact colors consistently once adopted. Science green should appear on white/light chart areas, not directly on navy.

Exact regional colors should not drift once adopted. The same region color must be used consistently across all charts in the same visual.

4. Typography

Primary presentation/data typeface: Poppins. Open Sans may be used for digital body text; Arial is the fallback.

Use	Recommended weight
Major title	Bold / ExtraBold
Section heading	Bold
Subtitle	Medium
Chart title	SemiBold
Large metric	Bold / ExtraBold
Body	Regular
Chart labels	Medium
Footer / source	Regular

5. Photography and Student Representation

Student imagery should be photorealistic, age-appropriate, diverse, academically engaged, and natural rather than posed. Students should support the instructional context or data story rather than function as decoration.

ELA Reading, annotating, discussing text, or writing in response. Icon: open book in LAUSD Orange.	Math Solving equations, calculator use, graphing, collaborative problem-solving. Icon: calculator in LAUSD Navy.
Science Experiments, measuring liquids, recording observations, discussing results. Icon: beaker, flask, or microscope in LAUSD Green.	Placement Prefer left, lower-left, or lower-third. Blend photography into the composition; data readability always takes precedence.
Science green #00602D should not sit directly on navy. Put a green Science icon inside a white or light container when the overall slide is dark.	

6. Core Layout Templates

RS-01 — Hero Data PHOTO PRIMARY DATA KEY TAKEAWAY Use for SBA trends, CAST, attendance, and single-subject dashboards. RS-03 — Cohort Analysis MULTIPLE GRADE PANELS + STUDENT IMAGE KEY TAKEAWAY Use common axes when cross-panel comparison is intended.	RS-02 — Regional Comparison P+A DFP or SP REGION SOUTH STORY Use for East/North/South/West comparisons. Light plotting areas are preferred. Dashboard proportion Top 15–18% title/subtitle; middle 60–68% visualization/photo; bottom 12–18% takeaway/logo/source/notes.
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Region South Style Guide — Validation Board v1.2

Four core templates tested against the consolidated rules

RS-01 Math Trend  Primary: #00237A - Blue subject family - Calculator icon - DFP defined - Direction-only preliminary trend - Logo inserted in post-production	RS-02 ELA Comparison  Primary: #FF4D00 - Locked orange regional palette - White/light plotting areas - P+A + DFP defined - South emphasized fairly - Source/date resolved
RS-03 ELA Cohort  Primary: #FF4D00 - Orange-family bars - Sign shown by bar direction - Green/red only secondary - Consistent grade panels - DFP defined	CAST / SP Science  Primary: #00602D - Green subject family - SP defined 65 = Proficiency - Green icon on light container - Source/date resolved

7. Terminology and Measures

Full term	Short form	Use
Proficient + Advanced	P+A	Higher is better. Use percentage points for differences between rates.
Distance from Proficiency	DFP	Higher is better. Values closer to 0 are closer to proficiency; positive values are above proficiency.
Science Points	SP	Higher is better. Scale is 0–100; 65 = Proficiency.

Whenever P+A, DFP, or SP appears anywhere in a visual, the full definition must also appear somewhere in that same visual.

Do not display PoA in Region South-facing visuals unless reproducing a source verbatim. Use Proficient + Advanced or P+A instead.

Use Distance from Proficiency, not Distance from Standard.

8. Data Visualization Standards

- Use accurate scales, minimal clutter, selective direct labeling, and fair comparison.
- P+A: higher is better. Describe differences between percentages as percentage points.
- DFP: higher is better. Keep negative signs. Use 0 = Proficiency when relevant. Do not reverse the axis.
- SP: scale 0–100. Use a benchmark at 65 labeled Proficiency. Never label it Proficiency Floor.
- Regional comparison: South receives the strongest emphasis without suppressing other regions.
- Cohort-change bars: preserve the subject color family as the primary encoding; bar direction communicates sign.
- Benchmarks should be subordinate to data: thin, dashed, and directly labeled.

Trend language

Term	Meaning
Improvement	Favorable directional movement.
Growth	Improvement across multiple periods.
Average annual change	Endpoint-based annual rate: (final - start) / elapsed years.
Linear trend slope	Regression-based rate using all observations.
Acceleration	The rate of improvement itself is increasing; not a synonym for ordinary growth.

Claims such as largest, highest, lowest, fastest, strongest, or most improved must state the comparison period.

9. Preliminary, Embargoed, and Internal Data

When an actual value is restricted, the visual must not reveal the value directly or indirectly.

- Do not print the restricted value.
- Do not terminate a trend arrow at a meaningful y-axis coordinate.
- Do not align the arrow with a gridline from which the value can be estimated.
- Prefer a direction-only arrow in a separate Preliminary Trend zone or use generalized text such as improving trend.

Preferred wording: Preliminary results remain embargoed and are shown only as a generalized trend.

For stronger internal notices, use: PRELIMINARY — INTERNAL USE ONLY.

10. Footer and Metadata

Preferred footer architecture:

- Left: brand identity
- Center: definitions, methodology, confidentiality/embargo note
- Right: source and date

If Source and/or Date are not provided, prompt the user before finalizing. Explicitly offer the option to omit either item if it is not pertinent. Never invent a source or date.

Approved date labels include Data as of [date], Downloaded [date], and Results through [date]. Use the label that accurately describes the date.

11. Using the Guide with AI

For ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or another image/design assistant.

A Region South AI workflow should resolve the following before generating a final data graphic:

- Display Mode: Light or Dark
- Source: provide or omit
- Date: provide or omit
- Preliminary/embargo status, when relevant
- Subject and required measures

Required AI behavior

- Ask the user to choose Light or Dark Mode if missing.
- Ask for Source/Date if missing and allow omission.
- Apply the locked subject and regional colors.
- Use Poppins as the preferred presentation font.
- Define P+A, DFP, and SP in the same visual whenever abbreviated.
- Use authentic logos only; reserve space if authentic insertion is not possible.
- Verify every value, label, benchmark, takeaway, and superlative.

AI priority order: Data accuracy > Brand compliance > Readability > Correct subject identity > Student representation > Aesthetic polish.

12. Approved Example Workflow

A generated composition is a draft until it passes post-production review.

Brand Authentic logos; correct display mode; locked subject and regional colors.	Typography Poppins hierarchy; readable labels; compliant small-text colors.
Data Values verified; fair axes; correct benchmarks; claims supported.	Metadata Source/date resolved; definitions present; embargo rules followed.

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Only visuals that pass all current checks should be placed in the Approved Examples gallery.

13. Reference Checklist

Use this before sharing or publishing any Region South visual.

- ☐ Light or Dark Mode was selected by the user.
- ☐ Subject color family is correct.
- ☐ Regional colors match the locked palette when regions are compared.
- ☐ Subject icon is correct.
- ☐ Poppins hierarchy is applied or an approved fallback is used.
- ☐ P+A / DFP / SP are defined if abbreviated.
- ☐ Numbers, signs, axes, benchmarks, and takeaways were verified.
- ☐ Source is supplied or intentionally omitted.
- ☐ Date is supplied or intentionally omitted.
- ☐ Embargo/preliminary restrictions are followed.
- ☐ Authentic Region South / LAUSD logos are used, or clean space is reserved for them.
- ☐ Student imagery is age-appropriate, academically engaged, and diverse.
- ☐ Every visual element supports instructional context, the data story, or Region South identity.

Every visual element should support either instructional context, the data story, or Region South identity. If it does none of those three things, remove it.

Canonical online assets and the machine-readable specification are maintained in the Region South style-guide repository.